

Chapter

The Mark of Your Earnings on Your Plate



Food and Money

Have you ever considered that your food is also connected to the way you earn your money?

Suppose someone cooks sattvic food at home with black money, that is, with money earned by wrongful means. Then its fruit will be different.

Now take a second situation. Someone's money is white money, hard-earned, come by honestly. It was earned through labour, while doing good to people. But by mistake they also ate tamasic food. That too can be a combination.

There is a third situation as well. Someone earned money with a rajasic disposition, and later, on a physician's advice, ate sattvic Ayurvedic food. Then, again, the result can be different.

This is a new way of looking at food. Is what I am telling you making sense?

Sattvic Food from Unjust Money

Now understand this more deeply. Suppose I steal heavily outside, cause people suffering, gather money by looting. And then, with that same money, I take food that is as sattvic as can be. Whether that food is stolen, or some rajasic food comes through a half-baked deal, or I myself come home in a sattvic state and cook it with my own hands.

Will this person receive the same phalashruti that one who eats sattvic food from pure earnings receives?

He would have done all this by snatching someone's due, by crooked means. The food may well be sattvic, but will the fruit remain the same?

A Pure Life, but Tainted Food

Now consider exactly the opposite situation. A person was very hard-working. He laboured greatly, he was very sattvic, and his conduct in the world was good too. Yet for some reason, because of his prarabdha, he had little money, or none at all.

The person facing him is deceitful, wicked. He mixed something into this good man's food, gave him tamasic food, mixed something wrong into his food after all.

So what will the result be? Will this person's devotion, his sattva guna, and the sattvic purity of his wealth not protect him even a little?

The Example of Meerabai

If that were not so, then after being given poison, Meerabai could not have digested it. But she did digest that poison, by the strength of her devotion.

Is this making sense or not? This is one more way of looking at food.